

Bold 9780 stars selling in India

The latest phone from BlackBerry - Bold 9780 has started selling in India at a price of around ₹26,900

The Daily on iPad

Rupert Murdoch's News Corp., is soon to unveil a digital newspaper exclusively for the iPad called The Daily

Bazaar

Nikon D3100

Compelling offer for entry level DSLR seekers

The successor to the Nikon D3000 is here, with additional features like a 14MP CMOS sensor, live view mode and full HD recording. Aesthetically the D3100 looks similar to the D3000 as far as the front portion is concerned, but there are a few enhancements. For starters we really like the sturdy rubber grip which lacks the infrared sensor. On the top portion just beside the jog dial, you have a lever to toggle between drive modes. There is a spring loaded lever on the top right hand side of the 3 inch screen, which enters the camera in the live-view mode.

One thing we would have liked is a dedicated button to change ISO levels. On the left hand side there is an additional

button which allows you to change the camera settings without having to go into the menu - giving thumb-nail size images to put the function in context specially in WB modes - which is nice. Customisable function button below the active flash button does allow you to program it to either one for the four - image size, ISO, white balance or Active D lighting options.

Picture quality is quite good with crisp colours. Outdoor pho-



tography in daylight did not throw up any issues. The LCD was viewable in sunlit conditions. Low light performance was quite impressive. Even

on pictures taken on ISO 3200, we noticed very little noise - a definite plus. Focussing is snappy thanks to the focus assist lamp in the front. The HD recording feature was decent. But we like auto-focus while live recording.

The D3100 is priced at ₹32,950 (with the 18-55mm lens) which is a very good price for this entry level DSLR.

Specifications

Sensor : 14MP CMOS sensor;
LCD screen : 3 inches TFT LCD; Auto Focus : 11 pt auto focus; ISO : 100 to 3200 (boost upto 12800); Movie format : MOV, H.264

Contact

Nikon India Pvt. Ltd.

Phone: 1800-102-7346

Email: nindsupport@nikon.co.in

Web site: www.nikon.co.in

Price: ₹32,950 (₹27,250

- only body)

7.0/10

Features.....7.0
Performance.....7.5
Build Quality.....7.5
Value for Money.....7.0

Specifications

Sensor : 12.2 MP CMOS;
Optical Zoom : 5x; Video resolution : 1080i; LCD : 3.5 inch touchscreen

Contact

Sony India

Phone: 1800-103-7799

Email: sonyindia.care@ap.sony.com

Web site: www.sony.co.in

Price: ₹21,990

Sony DSC TX9

Goodness of 3D in your pocket

TX9 is a 12.2 MP camera which is capable of shooting 3D still images. The surprising part is that unlike other 3D cameras that we have seen, which sport dual lenses (to capture the left and right eye image) for 3D capture, the TX9 does that with a single lens. This is possible with the help of sweeping the camera from left to right, which covers the image from the perspective of both the eyes. The camera then merges those images to give you a three dimensional image. User interface is quite easy to navigate through. You have around eight shooting modes including a 3D

shooting mode, Superior Auto Adjustment mode - which will click a burst of four to six images and then auto correct them for noise or other fallacies to give one clean image.

Image quality was quite crisp in daylight as well as under low lighting conditions. Touchscreen is quite responsive and we did not find any lag, though it is a finger print magnet. Visibility in bright sunlit conditions is not bad. The 3D shooting mode is useless unless you have a 3D TV to view the image. The 3D Sweep Multi angle mode is quite impressive as it gives you an idea of the depth in an image



by tilting the camera on the left and right in the review mode due to the gyro sensor. TX9 can shoot HD videos at 1080i resolution. The video output was much better outdoors in brightly lit conditions.

At a price point of ₹21,990, the TX9 is targeted at premium users. An ideal buy for those who indulge in a lot of panoramic shooting as the stitching of images happens within the camera. Do not buy it purely for its 3D shooting mode.

6.5/10

Features.....7.5
Performance.....6.5
Build Quality.....7.0
Value for money.....5.5